MONTHLY UPDATE

DR Congo: monthly update, September – October 2026

Edition of 2026-10-12 · compiled by Claude Opus from the documents in the Corpus repository

> *Developments summarised from sources published between the beginning of last month and today.*

SUMMARY OF THE MONTH · GOVERNANCE · FINANCE · ICT INFRASTRUCTURE · DPI · TECHNOLOGY · INCLUSION · DATA

Summary of the month

The digital minister said on 28 September that the Prime Minister has signed decrees creating a national electronic certification authority and an online administrative services window. The central bank governor signed the accession agreement to the Pan-African Payment and Settlement System in Nairobi on 18 September. Procurement information reported on 26 September sets out four 20-year concessions for 11,600 km of fibre backbone, and a private member's bill on protecting minors online was filed with the National Assembly on 21 September.

Governance

Strategies, plans and policies

Two World Bank-supported studies on infrastructure sharing, national roaming, local-loop unbundling and telecom taxation were presented in Kinshasa on 9 September, recommending lower duties on equipment and new sites and a central infrastructure database. No government decision on them is recorded.

Legislation and regulation

Deputy Alfred Dibandi Nzondomyo filed a private member's bill on the protection of minors in the digital environment with the National Assembly on 21 September, framed as a special law beside the Code du numérique and the child-protection law, with rules for children under six and under eleven and stronger provisions for under-15s. The text is not published. The Senate declared admissible on 28 September a senator's bill amending the Digital Code to bar children under 13 from social platforms, with supervised accounts from 13 to 15 and mandatory age verification; it went to a joint committee.

Regional collaboration

The country is one of 49 states that signed, with the European Space Agency, a declaration that Earth- and Universe-observation satellite data should be accessible to all under open licences, save justified exceptions, published on 10 September.

Finance

MoUs and other agreements

An Algerian state electronics firm and its consortium signed a protocol, reported on 4 September, for the digital and payments programme of the Kinshasa expansion project: digital equipment, electronic payment systems, skills transfer and a technology centre. No value is published.

New investments

Vodacom Congo said at its forum in Kinshasa on 8 October 2026 that it plans a long-term US$670m network investment programme, against an average of US$140m a year, and put its 4G coverage at 46.1%.

ICT Infrastructure

Connectivity

A cross-border route was reaffirmed rather than started. The Tanzanian and Congolese foreign ministries agreed to fast-track a fibre-optic cable from Kigoma to Kalemie in Tanganyika province through Lake Tanganyika, alongside a standard gauge railway link through Burundi and the establishment of a joint economic commission. The statement came at a farewell meeting for the Congolese ambassador in Dar es Salaam; no route survey, cost, financing, landing point or delivery date is published, and no Congolese ministry statement is on file.

The posts and telecommunications minister presented the commercial launch of 5G to the Council of Ministers on 9 October 2026, starting in urban areas, with no operator, spectrum assignment, licence fee or date stated; he had said in late September that government was working toward availability before the end of 2026. The digital-economy minister and his Central African counterpart agreed in Moscow on 8 October on the need to carry out a fibre interconnection between the two countries, with no timetable or financing.

Energy

A philanthropic accelerator announced on 24 September a demonstration that will add computing load to an existing solar plant with underused generation, serving more than 30,000 people, to test whether demand for compute can make mini-grids pay without raising local tariffs. The site, operator, computing load and start date have not been stated.

Technical Capacity

Assembly capacity for digital hardware appears in this repository for the first time, as a framework rather than a plant. The coordination office of the Kinshasa expansion project and an Algerian-led consortium agreed a memorandum on 30 August for an assembly and production facility at Maluku covering electronic payment terminals, cash machines and computers, with an innovation centre for payment technologies, cybersecurity and applied artificial intelligence and vocational training attached. No investment figure, production capacity or construction timetable is stated, so what is signed is an intention to cooperate rather than a commitment anyone can be held to. The regional programme's half-year report records the digital transformation project's unit operational and a US$10m Kinshasa connectivity pilot, against delays in validating the backbone investment strategy and late disbursement of the French co-financing, with a US$190m backbone tender and US$65m of last-mile tenders the year's stated priorities. The project's steering committee held its first session on 8 October 2026 and validated the 2026 annual work plan and budget, reviewing delays component by component and setting priorities to 2027.

DPI

Data Exchange

On 28 September the digital economy minister said the Prime Minister had signed the decree creating the national electronic certification authority provided for in the 2023 Digital Code. No decree number or operating date was given. The continental health agency said it was deploying the national health data platform for Ebola outbreak data and had sent more than 150 internet devices to affected health zones to replace paper reporting.

Digital Identity and CRVS

Continentally, the laboratory system the country's current Ebola response runs on was assessed before the outbreak began. A multi-country study covering 26 countries found every one with a functioning surveillance system and core diagnostic capacity and 3,964 laboratories mapped across fourteen, and named digital interoperability between laboratories and surveillance platforms — alongside specimen referral, workforce surge and domestic financing — as the weak points, which is where the response has had to improvise. It is a reference study written up by its own author rather than a dated development here, and the repository holds no national laboratory-interoperability position to set against it.

The identity pilot is hiring before it enrols: the ministry retained 50 agents from more than 9,000 candidates, to start training on 15 September.

The national digital identity platform moved to enrolment: its first 50 agents began training on 15 September, the minister stating that it is an authentication tool and not a national identity card.

On International Identity Day the identification office said preparations for the population identification system are complete and that data collection will begin in December 2026. No enrolment target or budget line accompanies the date. The minister delegate for the diaspora launched the pilot phase of digital identification of Congolese abroad at the embassy in Paris on 27 September and presented the registration platform in Brussels two days later; no enrolment figure or link to the national identification office is given.

Digital Payments and Fintech

The revenue chain's own record came into dispute. The tax directorate wrote to the finance minister on 3 September alleging deleted and back-dated receipts on the ISYS-REGIES platform, and the central bank replied on 10 September that validated transactions are traceable and cannot be altered, explaining the gaps against its accounting system. No independent audit is published. The national economy ministry announced the official national launch of the LOBA consumer-protection platform from 6 October 2026, through the competition commission and the sector regulators.

Registries

A second registry-shaped system was announced on the certification side. The standards control office plans a national QR-code system letting consumers scan a product — medicines included — to verify its certification status, with consumer checks stated as opening within weeks and resting on 88 laboratories across 29 sites. No launch date, register, cost or enforcement route is published, and the laboratory counts are the office's own. The President gave the government three months, at the Council of Ministers of 25 September, to define a single identifier for businesses recognised across administrations; no lead agency or system is named. The land affairs minister said implementation of the land law had begun, with digitisation directorates created, more than 350 officials trained and three of Kinshasa's nine land districts in the first phase.

Sectoral management information systems

The revenue side of the digitisation put a number on itself. On a broadcast accountability programme on 3 September the finance minister said monthly value-added tax collection had passed FC 320bn against an average of FC 280bn — about US$141.4m a month — attributing the rise to generalised e-filing at the tax directorate and the phased rollout of the standardised invoice. The attribution is his own, with no counterfactual, compliance rate or invoice-volume series behind it. In the same broadcast he named the interconnection of the three revenue agencies and a data warehouse as under way, alongside a digital public-finance programme he put at more than US$150m to be built with a Chinese network vendor — the largest figure attached to any digital programme the repository holds

for the country, and one with no contract, procurement route, scope document or timetable published behind it. The tax directorate began nationwide checks of the standardised invoice on 5 October 2026, after the moratorium ended.

Other GovTech and e-Gov

The foreign trade minister told the WTO Public Forum in Geneva that 93 of the 98 documents required for foreign-trade operations are now paperless, with the remaining five due by the end of 2026. The figure is the government's own and no independent count is held.

The minister said on 28 September that the Prime Minister had also signed the decree creating a Guichet numérique to give access to administrative services online. No service or launch date has been announced. The electoral commission launched on 28 September a programme to digitise the electoral archives produced since 2005 into a single document repository, with training for 762 staff; no cost or funder is stated.

Technology

AI

The digital economy ministry announced in a communiqué of 22 September that Anthropic's Claude is officially available in the country, for Claude.ai and commercial API access, citing approaches it had made to the company. No terms were given. A private survey of 2,280 adults in the 26 provincial capitals found 61% aware of artificial intelligence in March 2026, against 54% a year earlier.

Innovation ecosystem

The World Bank-financed digital transformation project and the TRANSFORME business-plan competition signed a protocol on 18 September 2026 for COPA Digital, a competition to select, fund and coach digital start-ups, SMEs and incubators, with a pilot first cycle of about sixteen months. The digital economy minister visited a Russian innovation centre as a model for a planned technology park and sovereign data centre in Kinshasa.

Inclusion

Digital divides

For the school year that opened on 1 September, the education and health ministries provide distance teaching by worksheets and radio and television broadcasts in the 18 educational sub-divisions classed as high Ebola risk, designed so that families need neither internet access nor digital equipment.

Data

National statistics

The central census bureau's technical coordinator said on 1 September that the cartography phase of the second general population census is under way with digital tools and satellite imagery. No enumeration date is published. Census cartography was launched on 28 September, the operation costed at USD 192 million with general enumeration from July 2027; ministers said the census counts residents and identifies no one.

Open data

The gap the open-data portal does not cover was named from outside government. The national academy of sciences called for a national policy on the management and security of environmental data, setting the absence against an observing network that carried more than 125 synoptic weather stations and 400 hydrometric stations in the 1960s, few of which still work. It is an academic call rather than a government commitment: no draft, sponsoring ministry or timetable exists, and the station counts are the study's own historical figures — which is itself the finding, since nothing more recent is published.

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